FINTECH · GO-TO-MARKET · MARKET ENTRY

Don't fight the customer. Start where India already saves.

How Stable Money turned the fixed deposit — a product most fintechs treated as boring — into a distribution business, a trust strategy, and a ladder into bonds.

60 lakh+

Users across 3,500+ cities, as stated on the company site[1]

₹9,761 cr

Total FD investments on the homepage counter, 9 Oct 2026[1]

$175 mn

Valuation at the Feb 2026 pre-Series C, led by Peak XV[3]

Up to 8.50%

Highest partner FD rate on the live shelf that day[1]

A case about category choice, not about a higher rate.

Most Indian fintech of the last decade tried to pull savers into equities and mutual funds. Stable Money, founded in 2022 in Bengaluru by Saurabh Jain and Harish Reddy, started from the opposite observation: the country already had a savings product it understood.

FOUNDER THESIS

"If you want financialisation, the route was not to get people directly into mutual funds or stocks. It is very important to honour the beliefs of the customers." Jain's own family invested in FDs. The gap he saw was not awareness. It was that booking a better FD was still a branch problem.[4]

WHAT THIS CASE EXAMINES

How the product actually works, who pays, how the company acquires and keeps a cautious saver, where it sits against banks and bond apps, and which constraints — insurance, take-rate, the rate cycle — decide whether the strategy compounds.

FOUR STRATEGIC CHOICES

- Own fixed income. Do not become an equity app.
- Borrow trust from banks and DICGC. Educate after the first FD, not before.
- Win tier-2 India with an app, then add a person where a screen is not enough.
- Walk the same customer one step up: FD, then bonds, then only what still feels stable.

WHO BUILT IT

Jain is an IIT Bombay graduate. He scaled cities at Swiggy, then helped build Navi's mutual-fund business with Sachin Bansal. Reddy came from the brokerage Estee. The operating company is Stable-Alpha Technologies Pvt. Ltd.[4,7]

A fixed-income shelf, not a bank.

FDs went live in August 2023. Two years later the company was already describing itself as a trust business that had found its pace.[2]

WHAT IT IS

A marketplace to compare and book fixed deposits and recurring deposits, plus bonds and an FD-backed card. The customer does not open a new savings account.

WHAT IT IS NOT

It does not hold or pool money. The customer pays the chosen bank or NBFC. The deposit is issued in the customer's name.[1]

WHO IT SERVES

Median age 28. About 60% of users are in tier-2 cities. Seniors are a small share of customers and a large share of assets.[2,4]

HOW IT GETS PAID

Sourcing commissions from bank and NBFC partners. Jain has described a blended margin of about 0.6% on assets.[6]

MARKER	FIGURE	WHEN, AND WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEASURES
AUM	₹4,000 crore · 1.25 lakh deposits	December 2025. Outstanding assets, per the founder. Target then: triple AUM by end-2026.[2]
Facilitated	₹5,000 crore+ · 4 million investors	February 2026. Investments facilitated across FDs, bonds and related products.[3]
Homepage	₹9,761 crore · 60 lakh+ users	9 October 2026. "Total FD investments," a running bookings counter — not the same as AUM. A new FD every ~60 seconds. Cities: 3,500+.[1]
FY25	₹104 crore revenue · ₹45 crore loss	Operating revenue and loss, as cited from Tracxn. EBITDA loss also ₹45 crore. Still in a growth-over-profit phase.[3]

A huge, trusted, badly distributed product.

18–23 cr

INDIANS ALREADY IN FDS

Jain has put the figure above 18 crore. The company has also cited over 23 crore. Either way, this is the default savings instrument, and FD stock has been growing near 12% a year.[4,6]

~150–300 bps

THE RATE GAP THAT SELLS

Small finance banks pay a premium because they lack the cheap current-account float of SBI or HDFC. On 9 Oct 2026 the shelf topped out at 8.50%. Large-bank retail FDs have sat nearer the mid-6s.[1,2]

₹5 lakh

THE INSURANCE THAT TRAVELS

DICGC, owned by the RBI, covers principal plus interest up to ₹5 lakh per depositor, per bank. A bank FD booked in the app is the bank's FD. An NBFC FD is not covered.[1]

WHY THE WINDOW OPENED

- A high-rate cycle made the "boring" product visibly better than a savings account.
- eKYC, UPI and video KYC removed the branch visit and the new-account requirement.
- After an equity-first decade, a slice of younger savers wanted predictability more than a dashboard.[2]
- SFBs and NBFCs needed deposits and would pay for digital distribution they could not build city by city.

THE WHITESPACE

Groww, Zerodha and bank apps could all show an FD. Almost none of them were willing to be about FDs. Stable Money took the unfashionable job: one place to see the rates, book without a new relationship, and track deposits that used to live in five passbooks.

For the lender, the app is a deposit-gathering channel. For the saver, it is a comparison and a convenience layer. The yield is the bank's. The product is the distribution.[2,7]

Five steps. The money never sits with the app.

01

Compare

One screen of live FD rates across banks and NBFCs. Tenure, payout and features sit next to the headline yield.

02

Choose

The customer picks a partner and a job: highest rate, a one-year lock, monthly income, or instant liquidity.

03

KYC with the bank

Identity is completed with the institution that will issue the deposit. No new savings account is required.

04

Pay the bank

Funds move from the customer's existing account to the bank or NBFC. Stable Money does not custody the principal.

05

Track and exit

The receipt, renewal and withdrawal live in the app. At maturity, money returns to the customer's own account.

THE FIVE PROMISES ON THE SITE

Insured · Regulated · Direct · Convenient · Human. Bank deposits carry DICGC cover. Every partner is an RBI-licensed bank or NBFC. A person answers, in the customer's language — 43,000+ questions and 1,17,000+ minutes of walk-throughs, by the company's count.[1]

SHELF ON 9 OCTOBER 2026 – HIGHEST RATE SHOWN PER PARTNER

- Unity SFB 8.50%
- Suryoday SFB 8.50%
- Ujjivan SFB 8.30%
- Utkarsh SFB 8.25%
- Shivalik SFB 8.25%
- Bajaj Finance 8.15%
- Shriram Finance 8.00%
- AU SFB 7.90%
- + IndusInd, RBL, slice, Mahindra, SIB, IOB

A ladder that stays inside “stable.”

The company has been explicit: no equity products in the near term. REITs are under review because they still fit the promise.[3]

FD — the habit
Core product. Bank and NBFC deposits. This is the first transaction and the brand.

RD — the salary saver
Same rails, monthly. Matches how a 28-year-old actually earns.

Bonds — one step up
Stable Bonds, through SEBI-registered broker Stable Broking. Sold as +2–3% over an FD, not as a market product.[2,8]

Gold and silver via mutual funds
Not digital gold. A regulated version of an allocation customers already make in their heads.[2]

FD-backed card · REITs later
A secured card so credit sits on top of a deposit. REITs evaluated; equities declined.[3,8]

THEY DO NOT ALL CHASE THE RATE

Only about 40% of FDs go into the highest-interest product. Many customers arrive with a tenure or a liquidity need and optimise for that. The acquisition hook is the rate. The catalogue has to serve the constraint.[2]

THE BOND ATTACH IS THE STRATEGY WORKING

By December 2025, 23% of FD customers had also bought bonds. By April 2026, 26% of people who started with an FD had gone on to bonds, and 81% of bond investors on the platform were first-time bond buyers.[2,4]

THE BET

India’s retail bond market will not be built by equity investors climbing down the risk curve. It will be built by FD customers climbing one step up — and only after they have already transacted.

A thin fee on a very large, sticky stock.

DEMAND SIDE · THE SAVER

Pays nothing extra for distribution. Gets a higher rate than a large-bank FD, one login for many deposits, and an exit back to their own account. Switching cost is low at first booking and higher once several FDs, an RD and a bond sit in the same app.

SUPPLY SIDE · THE LENDER

SFBs and deposit-taking NBFCs need retail liabilities and cannot match SBI's branch grid. They pay a sourcing commission for customers who would never have walked into their branch. Early on, that commission was the whole model. Volume is what improves it.[7]

UNIT ECONOMICS, AS STATED

About 0.6% blended margin on assets under management. Revenue therefore follows the stock of deposits, renewals included, not just new bookings. Management's profit target: end of FY27. Until then, assets and users come first.[2,6]

WHY FY25 STILL LOST MONEY

Reported operating revenue of ₹104 crore against a ₹45 crore loss. That is what a sub-1% take-rate looks like while the company is still buying trust: brand, people on the phone, city teams, and bank integrations. Jain's line in late 2025 was that the first meaningful asset base took 14 months, and the company was by then adding a similar amount in about a month. Scale is the plan for the margin to matter.[2,3]

WHAT HAS TO STAY TRUE

- Partners keep paying for deposits, which they will only while their own branch cost is higher.
- Customers renew. A one-time booking at 0.6% does not build a firm.
- The bond step-up carries a better fee than a plain bank FD, without breaking the safety story.
- Support costs per account fall as the base compounds. The 24×7 human promise is a cost centre on purpose.

Trust first. Geography second. Education third.

01 · ENTER THE BELIEF

Do not ask a first-time serious investor to learn markets. Ask them to book the FD they already believe in, at a better rate, from the phone.

02 · TRANSACT, THEN TEACH

The first completed FD is the education. After that, the same person will listen to a bond. Before that, a curriculum loses to a cousin's advice.[4]

03 · ACQUIRE ON RATE

The ad is 8% versus a large bank's mid-6s. The product then has to satisfy the 60% who do not take the top rate.

04 · LET FAMILIES SELL

About 20% of customers arrive by referral. In this category the channel is a parent, a spouse, or a WhatsApp group.[4]

WHO THE CAMPAIGN IS FOR

Not the retiree the industry assumed, and not the day-trader fintech already owns. Median age 28. Around 60% tier-2. They know how to earn. They are learning how not to lose it. Older users are often brought in by their children — and they bring the balances.

MASS TRUST, NOT FINTECH COOL

The app listing ties the brand to Kaun Banega Crorepati: a quiz inside the app, a path to the hot seat, audience passes. That is a Bharat media buy. It borrows the most trusted half-hour on Indian television, which is the same move as borrowing DICGC.[8]

A PERSON, WHEN THE APP STALLS

Digital covers 3,500+ cities. It does not close everyone. A Kolkata pilot put a small team in front of customers, in a city with a fixed-income culture. Delhi and Pune followed. The pre-Series C is partly for more of this.[2,3]

Run both sides, and refuse the rest.

SUPPLY MANAGEMENT

- Curate a bookable set – the site leads with 11 banks and 3 NBFCs – and show a wider comparison shelf so the app is the place rates are checked, even before a booking.[1]
- Mix SFBs (the yield) with a few familiar private and public banks (the comfort). IndusInd, RBL, South Indian Bank and Indian Overseas Bank sit on the same ticker as Unity and Suryoday.
- Negotiate the features that are not the rate: instant withdrawal, penalty-free exits on select deposits, monthly payout. Those are how 60% of bookers choose.[2]

DEMAND MANAGEMENT

- Keep the promise narrow. "You don't want to be everything for a customer." Depth in fixed income beats a wealth supermarket.[4]
- Use the FD as a qualification. Bonds are offered to people who have already trusted the app with a deposit.
- Spend human time on the first FD, the renewal and the withdrawal. That is the retention system, not a helpdesk afterthought.[1]
- Growth stays organic. Management has ruled out acquisitions for the near term.[3]

PACE

Fourteen months to a first real asset base. Then, by Jain's account, that same increment in roughly a month. The GTM bet is that trust compounds faster than ad spend once the first cohort renews.[2]

THE 2026 ASSET TARGET

From ₹4,000 crore AUM in December 2025, the stated goal was a threefold increase by the end of 2026. That is an outstanding-asset target. The homepage's ₹9,761 crore is cumulative FD bookings. They can both be true.[1,2]

THE LOUD AMBITION

Jain has also spoken of aiming, over a couple of years, at ₹30,000 crore of FDs a month. Treat that as direction, not a forecast. It is several times the stock the company has gathered so far.[6]

Everyone can list an FD. Few can be about one.

PLAYER	WEDGE	HOW THEY COMPETE WITH STABLE MONEY
Large banks	Balance sheet and branch	SBI and HDFC win on brand and salary accounts, at a lower rate. Stable Money does not try to be them. It routes money to lenders who pay up for the same saver.
SFB's own app	The rate, direct	Unity or Suryoday can offer the same FD without a middleman. They cannot offer eleven of themselves. The saver will not open five bank relationships to shop.
super.money	UPI habit, Flipkart	superFD sits inside a payments app, with a very low ticket. Distribution is the threat: they already have the daily open. FD is a feature, not the company.[2]
CRED	Affluent card users	Same "make FDs feel modern" move, aimed at a premium urban base. Weak overlap with a tier-2, age-28 saver.[2]
Wint, Jiraaf, Grip, InCred	Bonds and credit yield	Bonds-first. Higher stated returns, issuer risk, hold-to-maturity. They compete for the second product, not the first. Stable Money wants that customer to arrive via an FD.[3]
Groww, Zerodha, INDmoney	Full-stack wealth	An FD tab inside an equity brand. Useful, and not the reason anyone downloaded the app. Dangerous only if they decide fixed income is worth a brand of its own.

THE REAL CONTEST

Anyone can publish today's highest rate. The fight is for the second booking: the renewal, the parent's account, and the first bond. super.money threatens the first open. Bond platforms threaten the second product. Large banks threaten neither, as long as their rate stays a point and a half behind.

Depth on the safe side of the map.

Vertical axis is felt safety. Horizontal axis is how wide the app is trying to be.



WHERE THEY WIN

The customer who wants a bank FD, wants a better rate than the salary account, and does not want a new worldview. Aggregation is the product. Regulation is the marketing.

WHERE THEY DON'T

Anyone maximising yield will prefer a bond platform. Anyone already inside Groww will not switch apps for a 7% deposit. Anyone who needs a branch manager's face still needs the Kolkata model, which does not scale like software.

THE MOAT, IF IT EXISTS

Not the rate – partners can show that themselves. The moat is the renewed book, the family's second account, and the right to offer the next stable product without starting trust over.

Four rounds to $65 million. Profit is scheduled, not booked.

2022

Founded

Jain and Reddy. First equity round of about $5 million led by Matrix (now Z47) and Lightspeed. Thesis already fixed: FDs first, then bonds.[7]

2023 – 25

FDs, then bonds

Deposits from August 2023. Bonds roughly fourteen months before December 2025. Series B of $20 million at a $130 million valuation; Fundamentum, Z47, RTP, Lightspeed, Aditya Birla Ventures.[2,3]

Feb 2026

Pre-Series C

$25 million, Peak XV putting in $20 million. Z47, RTP and Fundamentum follow. Valuation $175 million. Total capital: $65 million.[3]

Use of funds

Bharat, not M&A

Tier-2 and tier-3 marketing, more offline points, tech and business hiring. Series B cash was not fully spent. IPO talked about as a 3-to-5-year outcome.[3]

CAP TABLE AFTER THE PRE-SERIES C

Entrackr's read of the allotment: each founder 15.35% (together about 30%, down from 36.7% after the prior round). Z47 17.9%, Lightspeed 13.04%, RTP Global 12.7%, Peak XV 11.43%. Peak XV's cheque was about ₹183.5 crore. Names the website itself puts on the "backed by" line include Kunal Bahl, Nandan Nilekani and Sriharsha Majety.[1,3,5]

WHAT THE CAPITAL IS REALLY BUYING

Time. If the stated 0.6% is an annual earning rate, ₹4,000 crore of AUM is only about ₹24 crore a year – yet FY25 revenue was ₹104 crore. The P&L is already wider than a plain FD commission on that stock: bonds, a book that grew through the year, and however "margin" is defined. The raise covers the distance from there to a FY27 profit, while offline distribution is still a pilot.[3,6]

The strategy is disciplined. The risks are structural.

01 · THE RATE CYCLE

The advertisement is the gap over SBI. If the RBI easing cycle compresses SFB premiums, acquisition gets quieter just as the brand spend rises. The product still works at 7%. It recruits worse.

02 · A 0.6% BUSINESS

Thin take-rates forgive nothing: support, offline teams, and a KBC-scale brand buy all hit the same P&L that lost ₹45 crore in FY25. Missing FY27 profit would mean the compounding-trust story was slower than the burn.

03 · "INSURED" HAS A FOOTNOTE

DICGC is ₹5 lakh per bank, principal and interest together, and it does not cover Bajaj, Shriram or Mahindra Finance. The brand leads with insurance. A customer who books the NBFC at the top of the shelf may not have read the footnote.

04 · PARTNER EVENT

The FD is the bank's liability. The memory will be the app's. One stressed small finance bank becomes a Stable Money headline even when the insurance holds. Reputation is the asset the model is built on.

05 · DISTRIBUTION GETS COPIED

super.money already has the daily open. Banks can ship a cleaner own-app. The shelf is not IP. Renewal behaviour and the bond relationship are. Both are slow, and both are contestable.

06 · METRIC FOG

AUM, "facilitated investments," and the homepage bookings counter answer three different questions. A case, or an investor, that treats ₹9,761 crore as money still on the platform will misread the scale.

What to take from it, and what to watch.

THE STRATEGIC LESSON

Stable Money's entry strategy is a refusal. It refused the venture default (equities), refused to educate strangers before taking their deposit, and refused to be a super-app. In a market where the customer's belief is the distribution, the winning product is the one that does not argue with the belief. The fixed deposit was already the brand. The company rented it, made it bookable, and is trying to earn the right to sell the next product in the same sentence.

IF YOU ONLY REMEMBER FOUR FACTS

- The customer pays the bank. The company is paid by the bank.
- The user is 28 and often in a tier-2 city. The balance is often older, and referred.
- Bonds are a step up for FD customers, not a second company.
- Safety is the marketing, and it is only literally true for bank deposits under ₹5 lakh.

WHAT WOULD CONFIRM OR KILL THE THESIS BY 2027

AUM, not the counter. Did outstanding assets actually approach the threefold target, or did bookings run ahead of stock?

FY27 profit. Management set the date. A miss means the take-rate cannot yet carry the trust machine.

Bond quality. Attach moving past ~26% is good only if the book stays a step up, not a yield chase.

Offline payback. Kolkata, Delhi and Pune have to produce deposits cheaper than the next metro ad, or the Bharat plan is a cost.

Every figure above is dated on purpose.

1. Stable Money homepage, stablemoney.in, accessed 9 October 2026. Users, cities, five promises, support counts, partner rates, total FD investments counter (₹97,61,03,80,012), and the "backed by" names.
2. Sayan Sen, "Stable Money aims to triple fixed deposit assets to Rs 12,000 crore by 2026," YourStory, 24 December 2025. AUM, deposit count, median age, 13% over 60, 40% top-rate share, bond attach, Kolkata pilot, Series B, gold via mutual funds.
3. Agnidev Bhattacharya, "Stable Money raises $25 million led by Peak XV," Mint, 18 February 2026. Round size, valuation, $65 million total, offline cities, 4 million users, ₹5,000 crore facilitated, FY25 revenue and loss via Tracxn, REITs, no equities, no acquisitions, IPO horizon. Series B valuation as reported there.
4. Debroop Roy, "Don't fight the customer," ET Entrepreneur, 15 April 2026. Founder biography and quotes, 18 crore FD holders, 60% tier-2, referral share, 26% bond progression, 81% first-time bond investors.
5. Entrackr, "Stable Money founders' stake falls to 30% after pre-Series C." Post-round stakes for the founders, Z47, Lightspeed, RTP and Peak XV, and the rupee split of the round.
6. Moneycontrol, on the Peak XV round. Founder comments: ~0.6% blended margin, profit aimed by end-FY27, ~23 crore FD users, ~12% category growth, and the ₹30,000 crore monthly FD ambition.
7. Early company accounts of the first round (Matrix and Lightspeed, about $5 million) and the commission model: Business Review Live; founder comments on sourcing fees and the decision not to require a new bank account.
8. Google Play listing, "Stable Money: FDs & Bonds." Product scope including the FD-backed card, the KBC association, and Stable Bonds via Stable Broking Private Limited, a SEBI-registered stock broker at stablebonds.in.

Rates, user counts and rupee counters change. Where two sources disagree, this case keeps both and labels the date — it does not average them. The 0.6% margin, the FY25 accounts and the cap table are as reported by press, not as re-audited here. This document is an independent strategy case for study. It is not an offer, a rating, or a recommendation to invest in the company or in any deposit or bond.